without exception thought that I was wrong. They considered me as a sort of Don Quixote trying to kill Eddington. As you can imagine, it was a very discouraging experience for me—to find myself in a controversy with the leading figure of astronomy and to have my work completely and totally discredited by the astronomical community. I had to make up my mind as to what to do. Should I go on the rest of my life fighting? After all I was in my middle twenties at that time. I foresaw for myself some thirty to forty years of scientific work, and I simply did not think it was productive to constantly harp on something which was done. It was much better for me to change my field of interest and go into something else."

So in 1939 Chandrasekhar turned his back on white dwarfs and stellar death, and did not return to them for a quarter century (Chapter 7).

And what of Eddington? Why did he treat Chandrasekhar so badly? To Eddington, the treatment may not have seemed bad at all. Roughand-tumble, freewheeling intellectual conflict was a way of life for him. Treating young Chandrasekhar in this manner may have been, in some sense, a measure of respect, a sign that he was accepting Chandrasekhar as a member of the astronomical establishment. In fact, from their first confrontation in 1935 until Eddington's death in 1944, Eddington displayed warm personal affection for Chandrasekhar, and Chandrasekhar, though burned by the controversy, reciprocated.

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1. For a clear discussion of the laws of quantum mechanics, see *The Cosmic Code* by Heinz Pagels (Simon and Schuster, 1982).

2. It is dangerously easy, in a delicate measurement, to get the result that one thinks one is supposed to get. Adams's gravitational redshift measurement is an example. His result agreed with the predictions, but the predictions were severely wrong (five times too small) due to errors in astronomers' estimates of the mass and circumference of Sirius B.

3. This usage of the word "degenerate" does not have its origins in the concept of "moral degeneracy" (the *lowest possible level of morality),* but rather in the concept of the electrons having reached their *lowest possible levels of energy.*

4. In the meantime, Edmund C. Stoner had independently derived and published the existence of the white-dwarf maximum mass, but his derivation was rather less convincing than Chandrasekhar's because it pretended the star had a constant density throughout its interior.

5. A differential equation is one that combines in a single formula various functions and their rates of change, that is, the functions and their "derivatives." In Chandrasekhar's differential equation, the functions were the star's density and pressure and the strength of its gravity, and they were functions of distance from the star's center. The differential equation was a relation between these functions and the rate that they change as one moves outward through the star. By "solve the differential equation" is meant "compute the functions themselves from this differential equation."